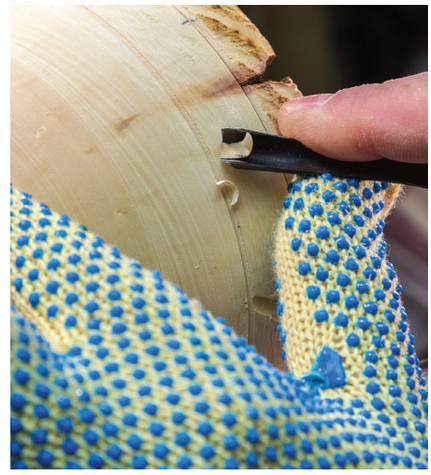
Very capable carving tools and sharpening systems are available at modest cost



Exercise care when carving and use PPE. I make shallow cuts then deepen as desired

available that will accept a variety of different carving cutters. These can be either purpose built or the special handpieces that will work when attached to a rotary tool flex shaft. In between both extremes is the hand-held chisel and mallet type approach. Wherever you find yourself on this continuum, you can take this adornment to the extreme you wish – from shallow sculpting to 3D relief scenes, all options are available to you. You may find that white gloves are helpful should you become extensively involved with carving. These clean room or photo style gloves are very modestly priced and will keep you from soiling your wood. Once the surface of the wood has been dirtied with dirt and oils from your hands, it is very difficult to remove and is very unsightly.

Key points

- Use sharp tools for better looking results and safer operation.
- Care in selection of carving direction based on grain orientation will pay dividends.
- Use an indexing head or drafting tools to aid your layout.
- Begin with shallow depth cuts to deepen later as desired.
- Don't worry about layout marks. Erase them when done.
- Partial coverage in a delineated area usually works best.
- Don't commit to high density until you see the lower-density results.

Woodburning accent patterns

If you mark your pattern as above, you can easily use a woodburning tool to burn your accent pattern. There are a host of woodburning tools that you can use ranging from the discount store craft woodburners to the very exotic pyrographic art burners. There are also many ways to create your own burning tips. In the more modest priced burners, this is done by filing the provided tips into the desired shape. In the more expensive burners, you can create custom tips for use by fashioning nichrome wire. You can take woodburning, or more properly, pyrography to extreme levels. Our goal here is just to have some simple markings to begin with. How far you might develop your use of pyrography is your decision. It is an art form that will challenge you for many years should you pursue beyond our simple beginnings.

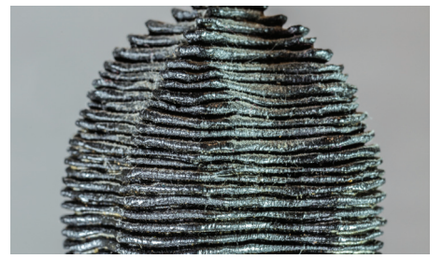
Key points

- An inexpensive burner will have a much lower heat recovery.
- You can file your inexpensive brass tips to suit.
- Lower heat with more dwell produces better results.
- Practise in an unseen area to develop techniques and settings.

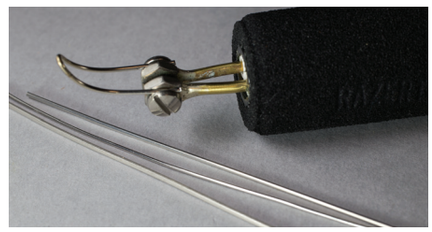
The modest woodburners lack heat recovery capability. The tips are also limited requiring your modifications

The higher-cost units feature extensive tip selections, variable temperature and fast heat recovery

The initial work laying out the fields for a simple pattern. You can be very delicate if needed



With a robust unit, you can sculpt the wood if you desire. There are tremendous creative freedoms



There are handles available allowing you to create your own tips from nichrome wire

Depending on your level of tip creativity, you can texture and sculpt with a woodburner

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